



LG 3D TV

LG Electronics unveiled an 84-inch 3D TV that will be available in India from November, priced at Rs. 17 lakh



Samsung LED ES9000

Samsung launched its new 75-inch LED ES9000 TV in India, with a dual core processor and motion and voice control

while the bundled apps are excellent by themselves, they're just not enough. The problem here is that even Microsoft doesn't seem to realise that. They want to revolutionise the tablet with an absolutely brand new OS, but have built no apps to support it. Even Apple had better sense than that when they launched the iPad. It barely had a few apps that took full advantage of that screen size, but then it at least had the backing of a vast library of iPhone apps. This is another of those devices that teases with its potential but may never live up to it and judging from past experience, might get scrapped at the first hint of failure. Microsoft is very serious about the device though, and considering that this is possibly the second piece of hardware they've ever produced, they've done a good job, and hopefully will decide to stick with it long enough to ensure it succeeds.

What surprises us more is why they didn't learn from the Windows Phone 7 fiasco. For a company that held a funeral for iOS and BlackBerry when the WP7 RTM was released, it was not fitting when they dumped it like a hot potato (into Nokia's lap) when they decided to move on to Windows Phone 8 and RT without the courtesy of a farewell speech. At some point in the development process Microsoft seems to have completely lost sight of their target in their haste to get the OS out in time. At the moment at least, the Surface seems like a decent device for students and might actually work out well enough with the right support. Moving on to something more cheery, Microsoft has laid out the upgrade

plans for us users and the prices are very reasonable (at \$40), especially if you're still on XP. The OS for PC use is still a disappointment though. They seem to have taken a Tablet OS and ported it to the PC rather than the other way around. This is very frustrating for us hard-core PC users and we feel it would have been far better if the OS would make up its mind about which version of the UI it wants to stick to. With the right hardware and touch-screen device, the OS does come into its own.

Google: Up to its own devices

Google at least, is unfazed by the goings on in the Apple and Microsoft world. Their OS is the most popular mobile platform and their Nexus devices are flying off the shelves. The 7 inch Nexus 7 is one of the most powerful and feature-packed devices and is probably the definitive Android tablet currently available. Rumours abound that there will be a Nexus 10 announced and by the time you get this issue, we'll know for sure. We're really curious to see if Google will respond to Apple's mockery of the Nexus 7 and what would be really fun (wishful thinking) was if there could be an all-out



Google – Paving its own way

flame war between the two companies. Google also launched a Chromebook this earlier this October, retailing at about \$250 (₹14,000), which might be a good deal for students and prolific Googlers for whom the PC is nothing more than platform for the browser. The only drawback is the continuous internet connectivity required, which would severely restrict its use in India at least. Running on a Cortex A15 processor processor, it is reasonably fast.

AMD: Hoping for a piece of the pie

The Z-60 APU (formerly Hondo) was announced recently and features a dual-core 1GHz processor coupled with an 80 core GPU (shader



AMD - Playing catch up

cores). This is AMD's attempt at delivering a compelling, tablet friendly chipset to take on the likes of ARM and Intel.

We would actually like to see this APU in more devices as even though the power draw is higher (translating to lower battery life), the performance benefits for a tablet device can be quite exemplary, especially considering the limited power of Intel's HD graphics when it comes to gaming. With the Tegra chipset from NVIDIA, it is possible that AMD lost this race a long time ago and might never be able to catch up. They also announced a new



High-speed internet finally?

desktop APU, the A10. Make sure to check out our review in the bazaar section this month.

Misc

Speaking of processors, Intel's earnings seem to have declined a bit, especially considering the lacklustre sales in the PC segment. The news isn't too terrible and if Intel can push ahead in the right direction, they can make up on that slight loss in revenue in no time at all. Their Ultrabook sales seem to be doing well and that is probably where they will focus their attention from now on. Good news for you internet junkies out there – if Radius Infratel has its way, it won't be long before we start seeing

blazingly fast 1GBps speeds in India. Don't hold your breath though, the prices are way too high for the average home user and there are some quite severe bandwidth restrictions. Also, how many of you actually use CAT6 cables? Airtel and MTNL are also planning to roll out high speed connections at between 20-100 MBps with prices started at 2600 and going upto 100MBps and beyond. The connections are currently limited to about 200Gb per month at full speed but are still way faster than anything else available in the market today. A 200Gb limit isn't bad at all. Unless you're a prolific pirate. 